

OREGON CITY COURIER.

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M. J. BROWN,

EDITOR

THE SQUARE DEAL MAN.

Mark Sullivan, one of the men who helped to make Colliers read from Maine to Oregon, has this to say of Woodrow Wilson:

"If the Democratic party should hold a primary election tomorrow, Woodrow Wilson would get fully two thirds of the votes, and carry about three fourths of the states. He is really the only one of the Democratic candidates who, outside of his own state, in the country at large, has a personal following—the sort of following that would go with his candidate into a third party if the occasion arose. Wilson has a large group of this sort of adherents; none of the other Democrats have."

Any man who has closely followed Wilson in his clean-up of New Jersey, is bound to recognize him as one of the country's few honest, great men, bound to know he is on the dead level, as he sees things, and that he would sooner be right than president. And when you stop to think it is wonderful how this man's character has made him so prominent in so short a time. Hidden in a college, only waiting for something to call him to public work, his bitter enemies of today were the means. The politicians, the wire-pullers, the ward-healers, the corruptionists found him and brought him out for governor—and then they found they couldn't handle him.

Woodrow Wilson may not champion all that you and I stand for—there are many men of many minds—but he can stake all you've got that if he is ever elected by the people as president he will be president, he will be the people's president and that no corporation will ever get him. This is my idea of Woodrow Wilson.

A SQUEEZE PLAY.

Judging from the comment in our various exchanges it is evident that there is not a county in the state but that would like to work the recall on the state tax budget, which is just about double that of last year in every instance noted—Newberg Graphic.

But we can't work it. When we get things framed up for this purpose a handy judge steps in and says our initiative petitions don't smell right, that they are not bona fide, just right, and denies the people the right to pass on a legislature's extravagance.

The state tax in Marion county this year will amount to \$143,000, while last year it was only \$71,000. This is a matter about which the people who pay the taxes are going to ask a great many questions between now and tax paying time, if not between then and election. It looks as if there ought to have been some extraordinary emergency to justify or excuse a hundred per cent increase in state taxes in a single year.—Woodburn Independent.

One of the "extraordinary emergencies" was something over five hundred thousand dollars of the people's money a misrepresentative legislature gave away to Eugene, without asking any consent of the voters who elected them.

Was there ever before in history the spectacle of the legal head of a great state using all the power of his office to further the work of a gang of forgers whose avowed object was the crippling of a school?—Eugene Guard.

This "spectacle" is one where the legal head of a great state is trying to give to the people their legal right to say whether a legislature of spoilers should plunder them with half-million appropriations. This legal head is trying to give the taxpayers of Oregon a right to vote on this great gift—a right that our state gives them.

If Oregon had more of such "spectacles" it wouldn't stink so strong. It is to be hoped the supreme court will sustain the "spectacle."

THE ILLUSTRIOUS CABINET.

That is a beautiful bunch. President Taft has gathered in his cabinet, and they are sure helping to get the big man.

Hitchcock goes off at a hitchcock and puts Taft in a hole with the big wire corporations.

Wickersham is overdoing his "trust dissolving" stunt and putting the people who are playing the trusts' game for 1912.

Knox is bulldozing Cuba and letting Russia bulldoze America all the while figuring to annex Cuba and get a chunk of China.

And what confidence have the people in this bunch of "policy makers"? Not a bit. They are simply shoving Taft deeper down in the hole.

The Cost of Living

is more easily adjusted to your income by the use of a checking account. From month to month you have an exact record of all money received and paid out. PAY BY CHECK, get a receipt. The endorsement upon the back of a check is proof that the party received the amount of the check. Start today and pay by check. YOUR ACCOUNT is earnestly solicited.

THE BANK OF OREGON CITY
The Oldest Bank in the County

DIFFERENCES

Springwater, Ore.
Editor Courier: The writer sees in a recent Courier that the people, unjustly, single tax, is advocated again. And to think they took so much time and trouble to get the farmers' tax would be less under single tax!

It takes so much revenue to run the county, state and government. Now look at the theory to exempt about half the taxable property. It shows how much reason and sense they bring forward to prove their theory. Of course the statement that was made about the 1910 tax of a certain party's improvements being taxed more than the land, I think was correct. But you take off of the improvements all the personal tax all the business men, the lawyers, doctors, editors and house and where will the tax come from if not from the farmers?

A. M. SHIBLEY.

Here is one answer to the above, the words of Henry George:

Try our remedy by any test. The test of justice, the test of expediency. Try it by any dictum of political economy; by any maxim of good morals;—by any maxim of good government. It will stand every test. What I ask you to do is not to take what I or any other man may say, but try it for yourself.

Here's another answer to the above: Mr. Shibley looks at only ONE side of the matter—the side of taking taxes on improvements. He overlooks the millions of acres of land that do not produce, land held by speculators and big combinations who never expect to make it produce, but who hold it because it will someday bring a big price, and because the tax will afford to hold it as unproductive land.

Under single taxation these men would have to pay taxes on what the land is worth as producing land. And here is one more answer: Soon there will be published an authentic tax roll of Clackamas county, showing the amounts now paid on land and the improvements, and showing what the same taxation would be under the single tax system.

This will be something practical, something in dollars and cents and something we can't get away from. And we can all well afford to wait for this show down before we condemn or champion the proposed system.

QUESTIONS—ANSWERS.

If I did not think you were too smart a man to make such a statement as this I would pass it by, knowing no one would consider it seriously, but coming from you people might think it was so. You cite several cases, but it is only necessary for me to quote one, as they are all paid.

"S. G. Miller is a small home owner in Gladstone. He has two lots assessed at \$300 in 1910 with improvements assessed at \$400, total assessment \$700. His tax for 1910 was \$14. Under single tax his tax would have been \$38. He would not have paid any tax on his improvements. How much does it hurt a home owner to have his tax reduced from \$14 to \$38?"—Courier, Jan. 19.

Now is it not a fact that the state and county assessors will make the assessment of property in the state and county and then take that assessment, and after finding out what they need to run the state and county will make the levy to meet that expense in cents and mills? Now by whom and by what means is this deficit of \$14 in taxes to be made up? It must be made up. If Mr. Miller pays his just proportion of taxes according to the 1910 levy, they must either raise the number of mills on the dollar or the valuation of his lots. Had you qualified your statement in some way it might have been that the state and county must pay the \$34, and it leaves a fellow guessing whether he come way or another has to make it up.

Yes, someone must make up that \$14 "deficit" that S. G. Miller would have saved by paying no taxes on his improvements and personal property. Then who would have paid it?

S. G. Miller lives in Gladstone, and he would have saved \$5.14 by single tax on his 1910 assessment. He had \$300 worth of lots and \$400 of improvements and personal property. His tax rate was 30 mills on his \$700 assessment, so he paid \$21. Under single tax his \$400 of improvements and personal property would have been exempt, and the single tax rate on his \$300 would have been a little less than 30 mills. Of course the tax rate would have to be raised under single tax. Now take the next one.

In 1910, H. A. Schliff owned six lots in Gladstone, assessed \$600. They had no improvements or personal property on those lots, and their tax was \$12. But as they had no improvements or personal property, they would have had no exemptions under single tax. On the higher tax rate under single tax they would have paid \$17.71 instead of \$12, or an increase of \$5.71, which balances the Miller "deficit" and leaves a surplus of 67 cents to carry to another deficit.

On the 1910 general property tax assessment the Southern Pacific and eight other big franchise corporations doing business in Clackamas county, paid \$70,197.37; but on the single tax assessment for 1910 those corporations would have paid \$100,075.72, or \$29,878.35 more than they paid under the general property tax system. There's a surplus that will take up 5,988 "deficits" of \$5.14.

Don't worry, friend. The books show a surplus somewhere for every deficit.

SORE SPOT—AND CURE.

If you taxpayers don't like the enormous state tax this year, don't swear, damn the state, and make yourself generally disgusting and obnoxious. If you would use your heads more and your mouths less, you wouldn't have such a tax to pay.

There is something for an Oregon legislature to do besides passing appropriation bills and adjourning.

But you have got to send men down to Salem who have the taxpayers more at heart before you will get a change. The appropriations of the last legislature would make even Tammany Hall's York state legislature envious. It was a awful bunch to pull out at one time.

The remedy is right in our primaries. Soothe a man out before a nomination. Know what he stands for. Make him get on record. Find out whether he is going to Salem to save your money or to spend it. That's the remedy.

BOOST IT.

It isn't a week of fasting and prayer that Governor West has proclaimed, but a week of backing up and thinking.

From the fourth to the tenth day of February let the men of Oregon to use their heads. To come alive above the ears and help figure out how Oregon can best change its public mud holes to macadam highways.

The Oregonian and other like striped newspapers will tell you that this is another of the governor's personal publicity stunts, but you and I know that Oregon will have to have roads before it can have farmers, and we are bound to commend the governor for the days and weeks of hard work he is doing to get the people together and frame up the best means to build roads for Oregon.

Governor West says, in six weeks this state has expended ten million dollars on roads, and the most of it has been wasted.

It's time to take a week off and think a few.

During this week initiative petitions will be circulated in the state to place the state committee's highway bill on next fall's ballot, and an effort made to determine the exact conditions of highways in the different counties.

ANOTHER BAD BREAK.

President Taft seems to be eternally doing the wrong thing at the right time—for his enemies to take advantage of.

A short time ago Charles W. Morse was sent to a federal prison for a long term, and the administration papers made the most of it as proof that the Big Noise could be jailed the same as the little thieves.

And now President Taft has pardoned him.

The reason he gives is that Morse can't live but a short time.

But the game put one over on Taft again and Hank Morse will supply rest for a few days at the Pindamon then so the papers state, take a trip to Europe.

If he would die he could let Taft out. But he won't. He was never even in danger, and you and I know it.

This man Morse wrecked things right and left and boasted he made the panic of 1907.

The government would let him out of jail long enough to make a million and then trot him back when public opinion was hot.

And his release is another one of those huge jokes the administration has been continually pulling off.

But the people can remember until next November.

SINGLE TAX ANSWERS.

Oregon City, Rt. 2, Box 86,
Jan. 29, 1912.

Editor Courier: In your issue of the Courier of the 19th inst., Mr. W. G. Eggleston asks me some questions which I will endeavor to answer, in my earnest desire to help every voter and taxpayer in the state to vote for the single tax. He would not have paid any tax on his improvements. How much does it hurt a home owner to have his tax reduced from \$14 to \$38?"—Courier, Jan. 19.

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A TRAMP REMEDY.

A bill that will go on next fall's hal jobs for the people to decide on is being given out to the people to look over, a bill to utilize convict and vagrant labor for the state.

One has to study this law to realize its importance, and when you do see all its curves it looks as if it might be just what the doctor ordered for Oregon.

Shortly, here it is:

It provides that instead of sending up the dozens of hoboes each night, keeping them over night and giving them on down the line at morning, as we do now, that they shall be arrested as vagrants, given trial and if convicted as vagrants, sentenced.

And when sentenced they are given over to the county court instead of the sheriff. The county court may work them, loan them to any other county, borrow from any other county that has them idle, and they are to be worked on Oregon's roads.

A small wage scale is provided, and a good behavior record shortens the sentence.

It is said the railroad officials will assist the different counties in the way of very low transportation, as this means promises them relief from a menace of hoboes, and it will be a practical matter to send convicts all over the state.

One result will be better roads at cheap prices for Oregon.

Another will be that it will assist labor in holding its wage scale.

Another will be, it will stop the army of men going from town to town, hitting kitchen doors and begging.

To the man who wants work and can't get it, this will relieve him, and to the man who won't work, it will make him.

From a quick glance this proposed law looks good to settle the tramp menace.

WILL IT PASS?

The house has passed the Underwood steel and iron tariff bill reducing the schedules 35 per cent.

This bill passed with 101 majority. Progressive Democrats and Republicans standing together for the reduction against the old guard, stand-pat element of the Republican party.

This bill is one of the most important to the general public. It reduces everything into which iron and steel enters, saving machines, typewriters, tools of every description, implements—thousands of articles necessary to the people.

Will it pass the senate? Will it pass President Taft? It remains to be seen.

The old guard newspapers tell us it is a bill framed up to put Taft in a hole.

It is a bill framed to help the American people OUT of a hole, and the silly excuse of political pin sticking won't go down.

If it doesn't become a law there won't be any use of the Republicans having a candidate for president this year.

MOTHERS.

A distinguished lecturer has been telling college girls that the "old fashioned" mother is out of date and useless.

Also—A certain editor makes it his business to lament the fact, as he sees it, that the "new fashioned" mother is being educated away from motherhood.

Now—Does the mother fashion change? Is there an old fashioned and new fashioned style of mothers?

Certainly not.

The mother instinct is the same yesterday, today and forever. Wherever a child is born there is born in the heart of the mother of that child a love that never wavers.

There are unnatural fathers, all too many, but unnatural mothers are extremely rare, almost unknown. Fathers they neglect and run away from their children. No mother willingly abandons her child.

All mothers are old fashioned in the respect that all of them will do everything and forego everything for the sake of their children.

Every mother is new fashioned. Doctors and nurses say that every mother, whether she lives in a mansion or washes for a living, is anxious and quick to learn the hygiene that will protect and save her baby.

Education does not spoil mothers. Do you know that the records show that not one of the hundreds of girls graduated from Vassar college has ever figured in a divorce court?

On the other hand—Nancy Hanks Lincoln never heard of the germ theory, but she was one of the most excellent and successful mothers the world knows about.

It did not hurt the mothers of a former generation that they were denied the means of intellectual culture, nor does it hurt, but rather helps, the

government of China has been overthrown and Standard Oil furnished the means. Now watch the Rockefeller milk the new republic.

For a sprain you will find Chamberlain's Liniment excellent. It allays the pain, removes the soreness, and soon restores the parts to healthy condition. 25 and 50 cent bottles for sale by all dealers.

It advertising pays at all, it pays to play it steady.

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ROYAL

Baking Powder

ABSOLUTELY PURE

Makes delicious home-baked foods of maximum quality at minimum cost. Makes home baking a pleasure

The only Baking Powder made from Royal Grape Cream of Tartar

No Alum—No Lime Phosphates

young mother of today who enjoys these advantages.

Mother love never changes. Every mother everywhere will give to her child all the devotion and help that are within her.

CLEAN AND I.

Clean hath a million acres;
Not a one have I.
Clean dwelleth in a palace;
In a cottage I.
Clean hath a dozen fortunes,
Not a penny I.
Yet the poorer of the twain is Clean and not I.
Clean, true, possesseth acres.
But the landscape I.
Half the charm to me it yieldeth Money cannot buy.

—Charles Mackay.

One day last summer I stood in a beautiful park drinking in the beauty of the landscape. A stranger paused and feasted his eyes on grass and foliage and flower, and I knew by the rapt look on his face what his keen enjoyment.

But Clean was there.

A rich man rode in his carriage and gazed wearily about. His thoughts were not of the trees and the birds, but of his stocks and bonds, of his per cent and discounts. He did not even see the park. The driver, whose eyes glowed as he looked about him, owned more of that landscape than did the rich man who paid big taxes to keep the park.

He was poorer of the twain.

Two women with faded faces lolled in their limousine. As they passed they talked of yesterday afternoon's game of bridge whist and of how Mrs. So-and-so "cheated shamefully." They barely glanced at the stately trees and the lovely flowers.

They did not possess the park.

And I said to myself, "These have a mania for possession, it is true—the millionaire for his acres, the women for their Circassian furnished chambers—but they own nothing worth while."

Said Robert Louis Stevenson:

"If we were charged so much a head for sunsets or if God would send round a drum before the bathwater comes in flower, what a word we should make about their beauty!"

Because we cannot buy the sunsets and the spring mornings and the autumn afternoons and the event of the glorious outdoors we are apt to esteem them too lightly.

There are Cleons who care not for landscapes, but for acres; not for beauty, but for possession.

To him who can see and love the wonder and the beauty, to him—

Half the charm it yieldeth Money cannot buy.

The government of China has been overthrown and Standard Oil furnished the means. Now watch the Rockefeller milk the new republic.

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